ENGLISH-VOCABULARY VAULT · PRACTICE SET 4

RECALL ANSWER KEY

HOW TO CHECK

Bold = the expected answer; grey after a slash = also correct. Mark every answer in your colours (blue / orange / red) and, for every red, colour one square next to its tag (`s` , `c` . . .) on the *Rundown* page. Chips like JJK MAR tell you which show and which month the card comes from — open it after a mistake. + NOT ON YOUR CARD = a meaning or fact your card is missing (worth adding). VAULT FIX = something on your card that needs correcting; they are all collected at the end. UK marks the British choice.

1 Vault scan

M

A ✓ only scores if your meaning matches. Then shade the bars on the exercise page and compare A (drilled in January) with C (never drilled).

A JANUARY (drilled)

withstand resist without being damaged — DBZ JAN
shrewd clever at judging situations — DBZ JAN
ominous suggesting something bad is coming — DBZ JAN
ponder think carefully for a long time — DBZ JAN
grudge resentment that lasts for years — DBZ JAN
ample enough, or more than enough — DBZ JAN
insidious spreading unnoticed, but harmful — DBZ JAN
thereby as a result of this (formal) — DBZ JAN
uncanny strange in a slightly scary way — DBZ JAN
loom appear large; be about to happen — DBZ JAN
brazen shamelessly bold — DBZ JAN
jeopardise put at risk — DBZ JAN

B FEBRUARY

breach break a rule; a gap in a defence — JJK FEB
deterrent something that discourages — JJK FEB
withhold refuse to give (info, payment) — JJK FEB
strive try very hard (for / to do) — JJK FEB
entrust hand over responsibility for — JJK FEB
plummet fall suddenly and steeply — JJK FEB
subtle hard to notice; clever, indirect — JJK FEB
ward off keep danger or illness away — JJK FEB
stir up deliberately cause trouble — JJK FEB
slack off work less hard than you should — JJK FEB
call it quits stop doing it; give up — JJK FEB
heirloom object passed down in a family — JJK FEB

C MARCH (the 644)

cope deal with difficulty (cope with) — DBZ MAR
convey communicate an idea or feeling — JJK MAR
deem consider, judge (formal) — JJK MAR
gauge measure or estimate; judge a mood — JJK MAR
heed pay attention to advice — JJK MAR
hindrance something that slows progress — JJK MAR
oblivious not aware (oblivious to / of) — JJK MAR
rampant spreading out of control — JJK MAR
scrutiny close, careful examination — MHA MAR
tangible real; clear and definite — JJK MAR
a blessing in disguise bad luck that turns out good — DBZ MAR
keep tabs on watch closely, monitor — DBZ MAR

D OCTOBER

be that as it may even so (formal) — MT OCT
convoluted extremely complicated — MT OCT
hone improve a skill with practice — MT OCT
impose introduce a rule; force on someone — MT OCT
wrap your head around finally understand — MT OCT
contingency a possible event you plan for — DBS OCT
folly a foolish act or idea — DBS OCT
pledge a serious promise; to promise — DBS OCT
harrowing extremely distressing — GT OCT
balk (at) refuse to go ahead (UK *baulk*) — GT OCT
seldom rarely (formal) — LIFE OCT
delve into research in depth — LIFE OCT

2 Decoys

M N

Score the definition first; decoys are a bonus. A decoy you chose is a nuance problem worth noting.

1 latent → **c** JJK MAR

Decoys: a = impending, b = innate.

2 leniency → **b** JJK MAR

Decoys: a = carelessness, c = distaste.

3 plight → **c** DBZ MAR

Decoys: a = pledge, b = plea. Three near-twins in sound — that is exactly why they blur.

4 forfeit → **a** JJK MAR

Decoys: b = withhold, c = disclose.

5 discretion → **a** MHA MAR

Decoys: b = scrutiny, c = flattery.

6 linger → **b** JJK MAR

Decoys: a = stroll, c = fret.

7 dwindle → **c** DBZ MAR

Decoys: a = plummet, b = degenerate. Dwindle is slow; plummet is a cliff.

8 engulf → **a** DBZ MAR

Decoys: b = ensnare, c = annihilate.

9 gullible → **b** DBZ MAR

Decoys: a = oblivious, c = sceptical (UK spelling of skeptical*).*

10 bleak → **c** DBZ MAR

Decoys: a = barren, b = glum.

11 devious → **b** DBZ MAR

Decoys: a = impudent, c = nefarious. A devious plan can be harmless (a devious chess move); a nefarious one is wicked.

12 meagre → **a** DBZ MAR

Decoys: b = puny, c = ample. UK spelling: meagre.

3 Here goes nothing

M F

1	H	E	R	M	I	T						
2	E	X	H	I	L	A	R	A	T	I	N	G
3	R	E	N	O	W	N	E	D				
4	E	Q	U	A	T	E						
5	G	L	I	M	P	S	E					
6	O	V	E	R	L	O	O	K				
7	E	V	I	C	T							
8	S	W	A	M	P	E	D					
9	N	E	G	L	E	C	T					
10	O	U	T	R	I	G	H	T				
11	T	I	N	K	E	R						
12	H	A	N	D	F	U	L					
13	I	T	C	H	I	N	G					
14	N	O	S	Y								
15	G	R	I	T								

1 hermit MT OCT **2 exhilarating** DS OCT
3 renowned DBZ MAR **4 equate** DBZ MAR
5 glimpse JJK MAR **6 overlook** MHA MAR
7 evict MHA MAR **8 swamped** MHA MAR
9 neglect JJK MAR **10 outright** JJK MAR
11 tinker JJK MAR **12 handful** DBZ MAR
13 itching DBZ MAR **14 nosy** / nosey MHA MAR
15 grit LIFE OCT

The phrase: HERE GOES NOTHING DBZ MAR — what you say just before you try something risky that may well fail: *"Right… here goes nothing."*

Spelling traps (tag F): exhilarating keeps the silent h *and has one* l*;* renowned *has no* k *(it is not from* known*);* tinker **with** *something. If the meaning was right but the spelling wrong, tag it F, not M.*

4 One word, three jobs

S

1 keen DBZ MAR

a keen on = *enthusiastic about (UK favourite)* · **b** *a* keen eye = *sharp perception* · **c** *a* keen edge = *a sharp blade.*

2 coast DBZ MAR

a *the seashore* · **b** coasted through = *succeeded with little effort* · **c** coasted = *moved without power.*

3 floor DBZ MAR

a *a level of a building* · **b** floored = *shocked, left speechless* · **c** give someone the floor = *the right to speak. UK the* ground floor *is the American* first floor.

4 sheer JJK MAR

a sheer luck = *pure, nothing but* · **b** a sheer drop = *almost vertical* · **c** sheer fabric = *thin and see-through.*

5 toll JJK MAR

a death toll = *number of deaths* · **b** *a fee to use a road* · **c** *bells* toll = *ring slowly.* + NOT ON YOUR CARD take its toll (on)*:* Night shifts took their toll on his health.

6 stem JJK MAR

a stem from = *come from, be caused by* · **b** stem the flow = *stop it* · **c** *the stalk of a flower.*

7 surge JJK FEB

a *a sudden big increase* · **b** *a sudden strong feeling* · **c** a power surge. *(*Spike *fits a and c, but not* a spike of panic.*)*

8 hail DBS OCT

a hailed as = *publicly praised as (headline favourite)* · **b** *wave to stop a taxi* · **c** *balls of ice. Bonus sense:* he hails from Porto = *comes from.*

9 lodge DBZ OCT

a lodged = *firmly stuck* · **b** lodge a complaint = *make it officially* · **c** *a small house in the mountains.*

10 strain DBZ JAN

a *pressure, stress* · **b** strained = *injured by over-stretching* · **c** *pour through a sieve. Bonus:* a new strain of the virus.

5 Volume knobs N

EFFORT: **slack off → coast → buckle down → work your tail off**

Slacking off = deliberately doing less than you should; coasting = cruising on minimum effort (often still passing); buckling down = getting serious.

RESISTANCE: **hesitant → reluctant → balk at → defiant**

Hesitant = unsure, pausing; reluctant = unwilling but may still do it; balk at = refuse to go on (like a horse at a fence); defiant = openly refusing, challenging.

TROUBLE: **snag → ordeal → calamity**

CONFLICT: **bickering → quarrel → onslaught**

Bickering is petty; an onslaught is a violent attack (or a flood of criticism).

LAUGHTER: **grin → giggle → crack up**

NERVE: **sassy → impudent → brazen**

Sass is cheeky and often playful; impudent is rude; brazen is shameless.

Turn it up — model: *I worked my tail off all week, so when my housemate offered a brazen excuse for not doing the washing-up again, I just cracked up.*

6 Mic check F B

A Homophones F

1 tail DS OCT **2 fare** DBZ MAR **3 feat** DBZ MAR **4 meddling** DBZ JAN **5 reek** DS OCT **6 sole** JJK MAR **7 flour** JJK MAR **8 long-haul** DS OCT

B Silent letters F

subtle — **b** /ˈsʌtl/
heirloom — **h** /ˈeəluːm/
numb — **b** /nʌm/
knack — **k** /næk/
wrestling — **w, t** /ˈreslɪŋ/
wrath — **w** /rɒθ/ (US /ræθ/)
reigning — **g** /ˈreɪnɪŋ/
psyche — **p** /ˈsaɪki/
doughy — **gh** /ˈdəʊi/
listen up — **t** /ˈlɪsn/

C The British /ɑː/ B

grasp, chant, slander, rascal, half-pint, laughingstock have /ɑː/ in standard southern British English (/grɑːsp/, /tʃɑːnt/). *Ample, anvil, dashing, scram, racket, tandem* keep the short /æ/ everywhere.

Ear training for voice chat: speakers from the north of England use the short vowel in all twelve — grass and gas have the same vowel there. So both pronunciations are British; the long one is the southern standard.

D Stress F

unPREcedented /ʌnˈpresɪdentɪd/
omNIscient /ɒmˈnɪsiənt/
exEMplary /ɪgˈzempləri/
caLAmity /kəˈlæməti/
sabBAtical /səˈbætɪkl/
conTINgency /kənˈtɪndʒənsi/
BUreaucrat /ˈbjʊərəkræt/
voCIferously /vəˈsɪfərəsli/
CONvoluted /ˈkɒnvəluːtɪd/
LEniency /ˈliːniənsi/

7 Compliment or insult?

N R

C — compliments: shrewd, resourceful, nimble, exemplary, feisty, laid-back, dashing.

I — insults: gullible, stuck-up, nosy, cocky, smooth-talking, pigheaded, obnoxious.

D — it depends: cunning, scrappy, naive, defiant, mischievous, portly.

Cunning: *admiring for a clever move in a game, negative about someone's character.* Scrappy MHA MAR: *in American English a small, determined fighter (praise); in British English* a scrappy match / scrappy notes = *messy, disorganised* + NOT ON YOUR CARD. Naive: *inexperienced — gentle criticism, not an insult.* Defiant: *brave resistance or plain disobedience.* Mischievous: *playful or harmful.* Portly: *an old-fashioned, polite word for fat — gentle word, sensitive topic.* Feisty *is praise, but some people find it patronising when it is said about women.*

Flip it — model (cunning): *That was a cunning move — you baited their whole team into the corner. / Don't trust him; he's cunning and he only looks after himself.*

8 Not quite twins

N C

A Stopping things

hinder ① **impede ①⑥** **thwart ②** **foil ②** **ward off ③** **fend off ③④** **hold off ③⑤**

a foiled / thwarted DBZ MAR

Foil *is the classic newspaper verb for plots and crimes;* thwart *is broader (*thwart someone's plans*).*

b ward off JJK FEB

c hindered / impeded MHA MAR

d fended off DBZ OCT

Only fend off *naturally takes questions and criticism.*

e hold off (on) DBZ MAR

hold off (on) doing something = *postpone it.*

f impede / hinder DBZ MAR

Both work; impede *is the formal, report-friendly choice.*

B Who works for whom?

henchman ① **sidekick ②** **crony ③** **lackey ④** **underling ⑤** **pawn ⑥**

Overlaps are real (a henchman is usually a lackey too), but these are the defining features.

g cronies DBZ MAR **h sidekick** DBZ MAR **i henchmen** DBZ MAR **j lackey** JJK MAR **k pawn** DBZ MAR **l underlings** DBS OCT

C Pick the precise one

m innate MT OCT

Present from birth.

n inherent JJK MAR

Built into the nature of a thing — risks, flaws, limits.

o seldom LIFE OCT

Frequency: rarely.

p scarcely DBZ MAR

Degree: hardly, almost not.

q merely JJK MAR

Only — to make something sound small.

r utmost DBZ JAN

VAULT FIX *Your* upmost *card calls it a variant spelling of* utmost *— standard English is* of the utmost importance.

s **ensure** DBZ MAR

Assure someone that… = *tell them confidently;* ensure = *make certain;* insure = *buy insurance.*

t **whereabouts** JJK MAR

9 The odd one out C

harbour — ~~a threat~~ → *pose* a threat

impose — ~~a question~~ → *pose / ask*

withhold — ~~a meeting~~ → *hold*

evoke — ~~a decision~~ → *make / reach*

forfeit — ~~a promise~~ → *break / keep*

muster — ~~attention~~ → *pay / attract*

wield — ~~an opinion~~ → *hold / voice*

hone — ~~a habit~~ → *form / break*

breach — ~~a record~~ → *break / set*

strike — ~~a conclusion~~ → *reach / draw*

lodge — ~~a compliment~~ → *pay*

tap into — ~~a deadline~~ → *meet / miss*

UK harbour — *your card is spelt the American way* (harboring). *Bonus collocations worth stealing:* harbour doubts, strike a balance, lodge an appeal, tap into a market.

10 Particle physics P

A

OFF: 1 fend DBZ OCT · 2 ward JJK FEB · 3 brush JJK MAR · 4 slack JJK FEB · 5 drift DBZ MAR · 6 pull JJK FEB

UP: 7 patch JJK FEB · 8 stir JJK FEB · 9 pile JJK MAR · 10 crack DBZ MAR · 11 suck (up to) JJK MAR

IN / INTO: 12 barge DBZ MAR · 13 butt DBZ MAR · 14 step JJK MAR · 15 tap **into** JJK MAR

DOWN: 16 pipe JJK MAR · 17 buckle DBZ JAN **AWAY / ALONG:** 18 chip **away** at DBZ MAR · 19 tag **along** MHA MAR

OUT OF: 20 snap **out** of it DBZ MAR

Pull off *fits the map less neatly — learn it as a chunk: you* pull off *a win, a comeback, a heist. 11:* + NOT ON YOUR CARD *your card has the noun* (a suck-up)*; the verb is* suck up to someone.

B

a **paid off** MT OCT

Effort that brings results pays off.

b **pulled** it **off** JJK FEB

Something difficult you manage to do.

c **butt in** DBZ MAR

Into a conversation.

d **barged** DBZ MAR

Into a room or a space.

e **ward off** JJK FEB

Prevent: illness, danger, evil.

f **fended off** DBZ OCT

Defend yourself: attacks, questions.

11 From the casters' desk P I B

1 right off the bat DBZ MAR I

2 on the back foot PB JAN I

3 ambush DBZ JAN M

4 fend DBZ OCT P

5 chipping away DBZ MAR P

6 holding DBZ MAR P

7 toe-to-toe DBZ MAR I

8 budge DBZ OCT M

9 stalemate / standoff DBZ JAN M

10 trump card DBZ MAR I

11 here goes nothing DBZ MAR I

12 tip the scales DBZ MAR I

13 crumbling JJK MAR M

14 shoo-in DBZ MAR I

15 pulled JJK FEB P

16 cracking DBZ MAR B

17 turn the tide DBZ MAR I

Left over: keep tabs on, call it quits. Cracking = *excellent, informal* UK. Right off the bat *comes from baseball; a British caster might just as well say* from the off *or* straight away. VAULT FIX *Your card is titled* turn the tides*: the idiom is singular —* turn the tide.

12 Suit & tie

P R

A

1 h tolerate **2 d** acquire **3 k** harness **4 b** diminish **5 l** withstand **6 e** evoke **7 i** neglect **8 a** withhold **9 c** relinquish **10 f** halt (left over: g convey, j commence)

The pairs are close, not identical: chip away at *is gradual (*erode *is even closer), and the most exact formal verb for* cut short *is* curtail. *Your JJK card* abide *gives the everyday negative:* I can't abide. . .

B Model email

Dear Professor Claes,

In short, our experiment did not go as planned: the sensor was damaged, and we were forced to abandon the test halfway through. We have also had a heavy workload with other deadlines and have fallen behind with the write-up, for which we apologise.

Would it be possible to have a short extension of a few days? We will make sure that the work does not accumulate again.

Kind regards,
Daan

hey prof → Dear Professor Claes · *long story short* → in short · *totally backfired* → did not go as planned · *got busted* → was damaged · *call it quits* → abandon the test · *swamped* → a heavy workload · *kinda slacked off on* → fallen behind with · *my bad* → we apologise · *can we get. . . ?* → Would it be possible to have. . . ? · *won't let stuff pile up* → will make sure the work does not accumulate · *cheers* → Kind regards.

13 Idiom exchange

I M

1 turn a blind eye (to) S PB JAN
2 pay through the nose D DBZ JAN
3 bite off more than you can chew D DBZ MAR
4 be caught red-handed D JJK MAR
5 a trump card S DBZ MAR
6 call it quits D JJK FEB
7 right off the bat D DBZ MAR
8 safe and sound S DBZ JAN
9 turn the tide D DBZ MAR
10 a blessing in disguise D DBZ MAR
11 a bad apple S MHA MAR
12 off the record S MHA MAR
13 put down roots S JJK MAR
14 a party pooper D DBZ MAR
15 keep tabs on D DBZ MAR
16 dust off S MT OCT

Left over: no skin off my nose, the writing's on the wall. *Fun ones: 2 — same face, different body part (eyes vs nose). 4 — both are about hands, but dough vs blood. 6 — English also has* throw in the towel*, the exact Brazilian picture. 8 —* sound *here means healthy, just like* são. *12 — Brazilian journalism borrowed the English* off. *Borderline S/D calls are fine if you can explain them.*

B Model translations

1 I **paid through the nose** for this kot, and the heating doesn't even work.
2 The professor **turned a blind eye** when we handed in the report late.
3 I think I've **bitten off more than I can chew**: three lab courses in the same semester.
4 In the end, losing that internship was **a blessing in disguise**.
5 He was **caught red-handed** cheating in the exam. (US: *on the test*)
6 **Right off the bat**, I could tell we were going to lose. UK also *Straight away. . .*

3 — present perfect, because it describes your situation now (Grammar in Use, Unit 7, says hello).

14 Broken idioms

I F B

1 mouth → **nose** DBZ JAN

2 ear → **eye** PB JAN

3 costume → **disguise** DBZ MAR

4 round → **square** DBZ MAR

5 sane → **sound** DBZ JAN

6 stick → **bat** DBZ MAR

7 of → **on** DBZ MAR

8 hen → **chicken** DBZ MAR

9 leg → **arm** MHA MAR

Pull someone's leg *is a different idiom: to tease them.*

10 popper → **pooper** DBZ MAR

A party popper *is the little tube that shoots out confetti.*

11 shoe-in → **shoo-in** DBZ MAR F

From shoo *(to urge an animal forward). A very common misspelling.*

12 might → **may** MT OCT

13 ✓ **correct** JJK FEB B

The British variant of from here on out *— your card mentions it.*

14 ✓ **correct** JJK MAR B

The British form; Americans say to make a long story short.

15 door → **wall** DBZ MAR

16 ✓ **correct** JJK MAR B

UK sink like a stone*; your card has the American* sink like a rock.

15 Where can I say it?

R

LAB REPORT — 1 commence · 5 akin to · 9 deem · 13 substantially · 17 thereby

EMAIL TO A PROF — 4 as of Monday · 7 by all accounts · 11 on behalf of · 15 all along · 19 be that as it may

MATES & DISCORD — 2 a cinch · 6 pipe down · 10 obvi · 14 bummer · 18 long story short

HANDLE WITH CARE — 3 schmuck (offensive, vulgar origin) · 8 uppity (racist history in the US) · 12 whippersnapper (dated, jokey) · 16 sissy (derogatory) · 20 tarnation (archaic)

Also fine one band up: 4, 11 and 19 work in a report too. By all accounts *is hearsay — fine in an email, odd in a lab report.*

Band 1 at work — model: *The measurements commenced once the temperature had stabilised, thereby reducing drift. The results were deemed reliable, as the propagated uncertainty was substantially smaller than the observed effect.*

16 Transatlantic customs

B F

A Spelling passport

1 **meagre** · 2 **savoury** · 3 **sceptical** · 4 **smouldering** · 5 **counselling** · 6 **manoeuvre** · 7 **instalment** · 8 **calibre** · 9 **ploughing** · 10 **unravelled** · 11 **speciality** · 12 **both** · 13 **both**

*The patterns: -or → -our (*savoury*); -er → -re (*meagre, calibre*); sk → sc (*sceptical*); double* l *before a suffix (*counselling, unravelled *— and on your cards* funnelled, pummelled, shrivelled, tunnelling*) — but* instalment *has a single* l *in British English. 12:* jeopardise *is more common in UK newspapers,* jeopardize *is the Oxford spelling; both are correct. 13:* spelt *is more British, but* spelled *is common in the UK too.*

B Re-dubbed for Lotte

1 **To cut a long story short**
2 **flatmate** / housemate
3 **too big for his boots**
4 **fully fledged**
5 **rubbish**
6 **socket**
7 **do the washing-up**
8 **from now on** / from here on in
9 **chilli**
10 **barge pole**
11 **hundreds and thousands**
12 **obvs**
13 **vicious circle**

All from your cards' usage notes except 2, 7 and 9 (bonus classics). 2: in British English a roommate *shares your bedroom.*

C Same word, British meaning

1 **b** DS OCT 2 **b** DBZ MAR 3 **a** MT OCT 4 **b** DS OCT 5 **a** DBZ MAR 6 **b** JJK MAR

1 mad = *crazy (Americans use it for angry). 2* bum = *bottom. 3* whacked = *exhausted. 4 a* scheme *is a neutral official plan in Britain. 5* the mocks = *practice exams. 6 a pub* landlord.

17 The Daily Vault

C M R

1 **soar** JJK MAR
2 **slashes** MT OCT
3 **engulf** DBZ MAR
4 **toll** JJK MAR
5 **hailed** DBS OCT
6 **thwarting** DBZ MAR
7 **pledges** DBS OCT
8 **rampant** JJK MAR
9 **breach** JJK FEB
10 **disclose** JJK FEB
11 **looms** DBZ JAN
12 **stalemate** DBZ JAN
13 **bombshell** DBZ MAR
14 **unveils** JJK MAR
15 **topple** DBZ JAN
16 **unprecedented** DBZ MAR
17 **farce** DBZ MAR
18 **spree** DBZ MAR

Left over: plummet *(if discounts are slashed, fares go up, not down) and* cull *— famous in British news thanks to the long-running badger cull.*

B Headline decoder

a Future: *TO SOAR* = are going to / are expected to soar.

b In the past — headlines use the present simple for events that have just happened.

c *The mayor has pledged to tackle rents, which are rising out of control.*

18 Taboo

M

One possible explanation per card — none of them uses a forbidden word. Yours will be different; what matters is that you never stopped.

heirloom — a ring or a watch your grandparents had, and their parents before them; it is passed down the generations and you would never sell it.

rip-off — when a shop charges you far too much, like nine euros for a small beer, you feel robbed.

shoo-in — the person everyone knows will get the prize or the job before it is even announced.

grudge — a bad feeling you keep inside for years because of something someone did to you.

sabbatical — months away from your job, often for a professor, to rest, travel or do research, and then you come back.

whereabouts — used when nobody knows which town or street a missing person is in: police are trying to find out his . . .

cliffhanger — the final scene of a series instalment that stops at the most exciting moment, so you have to watch the next one.

pep talk — a short, energetic chat a captain gives the team before a match to fire everyone up.

trump card — the thing you save for the very last moment because it is sure to beat the other side, like the ultimate you keep for the final fight.

knack — a natural ability to do something tricky easily:

some people just have a . . . for fixing bikes.

tinfoil hat — what people jokingly say someone wears if they think the government reads their thoughts through 5G.

landlord — the person you pay every month to live in your kot.

19 Hot seat

I R B

Three model answers (about 30 seconds each). Check yours for: the bold chunk, one marker, no pause longer than two seconds.

1 *Frankly, the biggest **rip-off** in Leuven is coffee near the library — almost four euros for a tiny cup. By all accounts it's even worse in Brussels, but still, I've started bringing a flask.*

6 *I simply **can't abide** people who leave dirty dishes in the sink for days. Every now and then I leave a polite note — be that as it may, nothing ever changes.*

12 *At the moment I'm really **keen on** running. I'm training for the Leuven half-marathon in April and, to cut a long story short, I've started to actually enjoy the long runs.*

UK keen on *is far more British than American;* I'm into. . . *is the more international option.*

20 Loot-box mini-saga

C M

A model with five rolled words — keen on *(3,3),* tinker *(2,4),* here goes nothing *(6,6),* plummet *(5,4),* backfire *(1,1). Exactly 50 words.*

Firmware

Keen on impressing my lab partner, I offered to tinker with the drone's firmware. 'Here goes nothing,' I whispered, and pressed Upload. The propellers spun, the drone rose gracefully — then plummeted straight into Professor Claes's coffee. My brilliant plan had completely backfired. She just sighed: 'See you at the resit.'

UK a resit = *an exam you take again. Check your own saga for: exactly 50 words, all five words, and the partners they need (*tinker **with**, keen **on**, cope **with**).

VAULT FIXES — small errors spotted while scanning all 925 cards. Worth five minutes in Obsidian.

1 **upmost** DBZ MAR — standard English is *of the utmost importance*; *upmost* is a rare word for *uppermost* (highest in position), and *of upmost importance* is usually seen as a mistake.
2 **turn the tides** DBZ MAR — the idiom is singular: *turn the tide*.
3 **reckoned** DBZ MAR — not archaic at all: *I reckon. . .* (= I think) is everyday informal British English.
4 **ponder** DBZ JAN — the "noun: weight" sense doesn't exist in English; it describes the Latin root *pondus*. Delete it.
5 **sluggish** DBZ JAN — the "noun: a lazy person" sense and /slʌg/ belong to *slug / sluggard*. Sluggish is /ˈslʌgɪʃ/, an adjective only, and the comparative is *more sluggish*.
6 **defiant** DBZ JAN — the verb section and /dɪˈfaɪ/ belong to *defy*; defiant is /dɪˈfaɪənt/.
7 **bound** JJK MAR — add the everyday sense *be bound to* = be certain to: *You're bound to pass.*
8 **sink like a rock** JJK MAR — add the British *sink like a stone*; and the idiom in its notes is *drop like flies* (plural).
9 **bit off** DBZ MAR — the idiom is fixed: *bite off more than you can chew* (not *handle* or *swallow*).
10 **skin off** MHA MAR — British speakers usually say *no skin off my nose*; *back* is more American.
11 **unheard** DBZ MAR — the card defines *unheard-of* (never known before); plain *unheard* means not listened to: *her pleas went unheard*.
12 **scrappy** MHA MAR — add the British sense: *a scrappy match / scrappy notes* = messy, disorganised.